Julian Heide

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Max Planck Institute for Political and Social Science
Department Inequality, Transformation, and Conflict
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Research Interests

Social Change & Post-Socialist Transformations, Media & Attitude Formation, Climate Change, Mixed Methods, Text-as-Data, Survey Research

Academic Positions

since 04/2026	**POSTDOCTORAL RESEARCH FELLOW**, Max Planck Institute for Political and Social Science
2022-2026	**PH.D. RESEARCHER,** Department of Social Sciences, Humboldt University Berlin
03/2025-06/2025	**VISITING RESEARCHER**, European University Institute (EUI) Florence, Social and Political Science Department
2022-2026	**AFFILIATED RESEARCHER,** SCRIPTS Cluster of Excellence, *Contestations of the Liberal Script*, Free University Berlin
2018-2021	**RESEARCH ASSISTANT**, Department of Social Sciences, Research Unit Macrosociology (Prof. Dr. Steffen Mau), Humboldt University Berlin

Education

2022-2026 — **PH.D. (DR. PHIL.) HUMBOLDT-UNIVERSITY BERLIN**

- Dissertation Title: *Mediated Contention. How the Media Shapes Trigger Points and Polarization in Germany.*
- Committee: Prof. Dr. Steffen Mau, Prof. Dr. Katharina Zimmermann, Prof. Dr. Hanna Schwander
- Grade: *summa cum laude*

2019-2021 — **M.A. IN SOCIAL SCIENCES, HUMBOLDT UNIVERSITY BERLIN**

- Thesis title: *Three Arenas of Social Inequality: A Poverty Perspective on Attitudes.*
- **BEST THESIS AWARD** of the German Sociological Association (DGS) in 2022

2015-2019 — **B.A. IN SOCIAL SCIENCES, HUMBOLDT UNIVERSITY BERLIN**

- Thesis title: *Housing and Welfare. Socio-political Preferences of Home Owners and Tenants in Germany.*

2018 — **VISITING STUDENT, UNIVERSITY OF HAIFA (ISRAEL)**

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journals

Dietrich, Jonas, Eva Maria Gajek, **Julian Heide**, and Emma Ischinsky (2026, forthcoming). Making Wealth Count. The Public Life of Wealth Statistics in Postwar and Contemporary Germany. *Historical Social Research.*

Thomas Lux and **Julian Heide** (2026): Generation Reunification, Generation Covid? – Visualizing Formative Events in Germany. *Socius*, *doi*.

Mau, Steffen, Thomas Lux and **Julian Heide** (2026): The Long Shadow of the GDR? On the Relationship between former Proximity to the System and Current Political Orientations of East Germans. *Zeitschrift für Soziologie*, *doi*.

Heide, Julian (2025): What Triggers the Media? Emotions and Arguments in German Press Op-Eds. *Zeitschrift für Soziologie*, *doi*.

Heide, Julian (2025): Polarizing Social Figures? Climate Activists in German Media and Popular Discourse. *European Societies*, *doi*.

Mau, Steffen, Thomas Lux and **Julian Heide** (2024): East and West Germans forever? Perceptions of Differences and Conflicts between East and West Germans. In *Kölner Zeitschrift für Soziologie und Sozialpsychologie*, *doi*.

Heide, Julian (2023): Test Case Poverty. On the Relationship between Inequality Attitudes and Social Position. *Kölner Zeitschrift für Soziologie und Sozialpsychologie, doi*.

Heide, Julian (2021): Home Ownership, Socio-political Attitudes and Region. A Study on Socio-Political Preferences among Homeowners and Tenants in Germany. *Zeitschrift für Sozialreform* 67(2), pp.153–182, *doi*.

Other Publications

Heide, Julian (2025): Review of Armin Nassehi's book "Kritik der großen Geste: Anders über gesellschaftliche Transformation nachdenken". *Soziologische Revue*. *Link*

Clemens, Simon; Lorena Drakula and **Julian Heide** (2024): U.S. vs. Them. How Populism and Polarization Challenge the Liberal Order. *SCRIPTS Working Paper* No. 49, Berlin: Cluster of Excellence 2055 Contestations of the Liberal Script (SCRIPTS). *Link*

Heide, Julian; Steffen Mau and Thomas Lux (2023): Ost-West-Unterschiede in den Köpfen: Alterität, Konflikt, Anerkennung und Förderung. In Böick, Marcus et al. (eds.) *Jahrbuch Deutsche Einheit*. *Link*

Heide, Julian (2023): Polarisierung von den Rändern denken. Was die Armutsforschung zur Analyse gesellschaftspolitischer Spaltungen beitragen kann. *SOZIOLOGIE* 1/23, pp. 91-100. *Link*

Teaching

Fall 2025/26	Seminar: Social structure, social inequality and demography (including supervision of term papers), Humboldt University Berlin
Fall 2024/25	Seminar: Social structure, social inequality and demography (including supervision of term papers), Humboldt University Berlin

Spring 2024 Seminar: Social structure and diversity (including supervision of term papers), Humboldt University Berlin

Public Outreach & Media Coverage

Citizen Dialogue of the Academy of Sciences, Pasewalk (Germany) 2025

APPEARANCES IN GERMAN MEDIA

Größerer Demokratieverdruss bei Anhängern des DDR-Regimes? **Deutschlandfunk** 06.02.2025. *Link*

Ist der Osten nur eine Erfindung des Ostens? **Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung** 18.05.2024. *Link*

Aufgelesen. Zeitschriftenschau im April 2024. **Soziopolis** 25.04.2024. *Link*

Armut macht migrationskritisch. **Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung** 30.06.2023. *Link*

Conferences and Workshop Presentations

2026

German Sociological Association (DGS)

Workshop *Transformation: An Approach to an Open Concept*. Zukunftszentrum für Deutsche Einheit und Europäische Transformation, Halle (Saale)

Workshop *Social Risks in Times of Climate Change: Inequalities and Attitudes,* University of Hamburg

2025

German Sociological Association (DGS)

Colloquium Analytical Sociology, EUI Florence, Italy

Spring School *Perceptions of Wealth (Inequality)*, University of Bamberg

Workshop *Social Change in Germany* (*Deutschlandmonitor)*, University of Jena

2024

German Political Science Association (DVPW)

PhD Fall Workshop 2024, The Institute of Economic and Social Research (WSI) of the Hans-Böckler-Foundation

Workshop *Trigger Points: Impulses for the Political Communication Research*, Weizenbaum Institute, Berlin

Workshop *Computational Social Sciences: Bridging Data and Methods with Theory and Application*, Bielefeld University

Workshop *Between Legitimization and Implementation of Socio-Ecological Transformation Policies in Europe,* Villa Vigoni, Lake Como, Italy

2023

COMPTEXT, University of Strathclyde, Glasgow, UK

Fall Academy on Perceptions of Inequality II, Cluster of Excellence Politics of Inequality, Constance

Workshop *Inequalities in East and West Germany – Persistence or Change?* Section Social Inequality of German Sociological Association (DGS), with Steffen Mau

2022

German Sociological Association (DGS)

2019
Summer School *Culture of Totalitarian Society and Memory Studies Cases*, Higher School of Economics, Perm, Russia

2016
Summer School *Ethnopolitical Developments in Times of Globalization: State, Region and Local Communities in the Post-Soviet Space,* University of Southern Ural, Chelyabinsk, Russia

Service to the Profession

Reviewer for Kölner Zeitschrift für Soziologie und Sozialpsychologie, Berliner Journal für Soziologie and Soziale Welt

Session Organizer "Veränderungspioniere und Veränderungserschöpfte. Zur Soziologie der Wahr-nehmung sozialen Wandels" German Sociological Association 2025

Session Organizer „Die grüne Transformation am sozialen Kipppunkt? Aktuelle Forschung zu sozialstrukturellen und politischen Konfliktlinien in sozial-ökologischen Fragen" German Sociological Association 2026

Representative of the "Mittelbau" at Humboldt University Berlin, Department of Social Sciences

Member of the Ethics Committee at Max-Planck-Institute for Political and Social Science

Memberships

German Sociological Association (DGS)
Section Social Inequality and Social Structure Analysis of the German Sociological Association

Skills

Languages	**German**: first language **English**: proficient **Russian**: proficient
Software	STATA, RStudio, MAXQDA